

Beaufort County Compost Program Presentation

Wow. What a warm, welcome. Thank you guys so, so much for having me here today. Like, Len said, I am looking for Native, and our environment is incredibly important to me. One of the main things that attracted me to working for the county is the fact that we all use the same landfill areas and that we all use the same facilities for recycling and for trash unless you have it picked up. And that's our Beaufort County Convenience centers. Um, why I am focusing so much on our landfill, slowing down, trying to maintain it, is because there are so many factors that affect us day to day with the landfill. Whenever there are increases involving, whenever there are more takeups, whenever our time frames run out on landfill life cycles or landfill timelines, we all end up paying more tax money or residential money, calling becomes more of a household than it is easy. And whenever these envelopes get bigger, it takes up space that could be used for residential use. It can contribute so much to littering. It can also just affect all of our waterways and our air. Whenever we have residents who live on the way to the landfill, we see most of our littering come from trucks and areas that are untaught, trucks and vehicles that are untaught. And these vehicles are losing pieces of construction, they're losing pieces of wood, they're getting trash, they're using municipal pieces of trash. We're losing fiberglass, and it's ending them in our waterways. The bigger the land is, the less maintain, it is, the bigger the chance that all of that can get into our natural areas in our green spaces.

As gardeners here, I'm so happy to speak with everybody because I know everyone here really appreciates their time on those and appreciates the space and being able to give that future generation so important. And we live on a landfill here, there are diamond frames on all of them, and we're even experiencing not Beaufort County specifically, but there are landfills in our area experiencing lawsuits with malodorous emissions, experiencing extra litter, There are folks in Bergyard Point, and where's James Point Road. Towards it? Ward Standpoint Road in Ever, where they are experiencing some The term is malodorous submissions and extra waste where they are physically unable to enjoy their cup of coffee outside. And they're not able to go on a walk with their dog because they're experiencing these. Yeah, these smells, these skinny smells, the non-scient way to say it.

So maintaining a landfill does not only affect our future, but it impacts us day to day. We are seeing almost all of our litter on the way to the landfill is from uncharmed vehicles, almost all of the ways that we find leaving the landfill, I love usually in our waterways. It affects the greenhouse gases. There's a ton of things that come with maintaining the landfills. The most thrown away item, or the most tossed item by American is something that we all do every day, and maybe so, so surprised. What do you guys think are the most thrown away item? Food. Food waste. What do you guys see the most on litter when you're walking outside?

Cans? I do see a lot of cans. I see so many plastic bags. So tough to get. Our number one throwaway item is food. Yeah, food waste. Food waste is our number one grownaway item. Why is that a challenge? Why is that such a challenge right now? First off, convenience and portions. When we go out and we grab food, it is so easy to just have it on the side, have it in the car, when you're done with it, it's almost always over portion, you know, it's difficult whenever you're purchasing to always share with a friend or just share with a group. There's a lot of time and effort and starting up the possible compost bin, or learning how to deal with your food waste. And on top of that, there's limited access. And that's why I would like to introduce you guys to Beaufort County's combo program.

This poster right here has a fun little key largo, and that QR code can lead you to our website, which will give you all the information I'm going to do today, but also walk you through how you could use our compost system.

This is what your word does. We are trying really hard to be one of the very 1st waste diversion tactics in Beaufort County in the last 20 years. Beaufort County started recycling over 20 years ago. So this is our first time. We are trying to manage our waste again, this time we are tackling it. It's a boom. Um, Whenever I think about composting, I almost always think of other spaces like more California, more up north, where I see it happening all the time. I travel to Massachusetts, like, 2 weekends ago, and they had compost events on the side. Beaufort County is considered rural and we're one of the only rural spaces of doing this. And that's really cool because we hear so much about our environment in our low country. We have been working really hard to introduce the county program because 4% of our food supplies never consumed. Right now, a family of 4 can waste \$1,500 to 18 to \$100 on food, per year, just toss down the grain. That's a truth to Bollywood. That's a trip. You can do so much with that. One in 95 Australianians are food insecure. These 2 facts always blow my mind. One in 9 South Carolina lineage are boot insecure. And then food is our number one item thrown away.

Wow. It's so crazy to me. We have people, we have children. I teach schools all the time on programs who are hungry, but yet we have all this wasted food. Thankfully, we have really cool programs like 2nd holidays, who we work with, and we take sometimes their, like, leftover hamburger buns. There's stuff that really cannot be consumed in the code of the compost day. But all of this is a continuous loop, a continuous circle that affects each other economically, but then also affects those who are good and secure and those who may be struggling with purchasing. So having the compost system is such a great way to help maintain some of those weights and to try to divert all of these items going just straight to the trash. As you guys all know, food is a biodegradable product. What do you guys think happens without me when it's in those trash pies?

It just was. Nothing happens to it. Yeah, yeah. But as you guys know, as partner,

when your food gets into our soil, they can, it can break down and it can become something really useful and really helpful. I want to introduce you guys to why we're pushing so hard with it with this little character as well. This is Loffy. Everybody say hi, coffee. . Moffee is super cool. She is my little mascot. I've been using the schools with restaurants with residents. She was developed with Queen Wet, who's our Belgian nation leader, and she helps make somebody who really looks like a secretarian, Victorian, and she has Spanish mom's hair, and teaches kids and everybody around about a recycle. So whenever you're at the convenience centers, you can look for momsie for information. You can look for her online, her website, and more graphics on how to start composting. Um, but also you can use her to share more information with those around you who may be interested in.

day. She is so cute and where it's here. Our grant program journey for this kind of started very rapidly, but also very early, or very quickly. It was in 2024, our funds were available. In December 2024, was when our pyramid started. June 2025 is when we 1st got our machines for the combo thing. And so a green mountain machine is massive. Like the size of the dumpster and it has a huge offer in it that goes left and right and up and down with a hose attached. So that's when that's our very first, that's our only composting machine for our 4 accepting locations. And the 2025 in December, the data was installed. And we just started in January 2026 on Posting. Yeah. So I checked the statistics before I came here today. We're over £16,000 of food base from our residents. So we have lots of people interested. We have lots of people who are willing to learn and are willing to help. And they understand why this is so important. I couldn't be happier with the speed of how everything's going. I mean, January 2026. I think we just finished up May, right? So that's really spectacular.

Some of our whole project wins is that this is the 1st time in the state of South Carolina government to have an in vessel composting program. So our composting machine is industrial and can take so much more than a regular backyard composting system. Whether you use a in or a turner or anything like that. In our 1st month, we had over 4000 pounds of food diverted and I right now have 3 schools engaged in learning how to divert their food and I'm working towards getting rid of all their food in a zero-based fashion. Uh, and this is, like I said, the 1st program in 20 plus years established in the county. Um, As y'all know, it'll be for county population is growing, but Beaufort County is not. Though the space is not bigger, we are gaining more residents, and if we don't maintain our waste, it'll get expensive, and it'll get hard to live with us throughout the days. And we've seen kind of the effects of having an unmaintained landlord, extra population, needs more litter, more food waste, all of that. So we're really proud of this, and right now we're working through all grants, and I'm working very hard to engage with residents to make sure that everyone knows that this is an option.

I know my partners out here, though, have probably all, at least once composted and learned about composting in their space. Today I brought a couple of cool compost crop examples. So these propos crops are just from the county. I got 5 of them, and inside of them, we have a burlap compost, we'll not see that. She can hold 2 gallons of milk. Really good bag, prefer shelf. Um, some sustainable baggies that you can use in the biodegradable machine in in the biodeg, and they violigrate in the machine. Sorry. A mozzie sticker, and then all of our information packets on recycling and composting with us. But about five of these today, if there are any residents interested in joining, at all of the compost centers, at the convenience centers, there are 3 one to 3 large green roll offers, and they all say compos on them, and you can see lovely mossy over them. That's that St. Helena. That's Lupton, Hilton Head, and Shinklin, all 4 of those out of the 9 convenience centers we have except Combo strip right now. And we cycle through every Tuesday and put it into our large vessel to start making our spill. Right now we're also taking from a handful, juice, smoothie shops, movie shops, and coffee shops, and to try to get all the coffee grounds to make some really good going posts. And for them, we do pick up service and we're hoping to someday extend to being able to pick up compost. Right now we can accept them as the standards for drawing home.

How many of you do composing at home already? Yeah. Awesome. That's pretty cool. I love that. I'm going to have to come see all your guys and Pongo's lobies. I love some 2 people about it. I'm currently in our office pushing for a group of posting, and I've had a full worm bin. Um, and that's our 3rd method of Congo thing that we've been using at the shop to be 0 waste to help get one of our new ways. Um, You guys are wanting to pass on the composing rewards. Please let me know. I'd love to bring them. They're my favorite. So to share with you guys our compost recipe. We right now focus on browns, greens, air, water, and heat. So with everybody who's already so familiar, I'm just gonna go through this really shortly. The browns are leaves, cardboard, crushed eggshells, lots of products that... Would typically be able, that would be typically able to go to our industry and also be used in backyard while hosting. And then, of course, fruits, vegetable tops, no raw meat, eggshell, and then any other green and old veggies. The really cool thing about using composting with us is that you can do eggs and show, coffee grounds, tea bags, processed foods, come to meats, which you typically wouldn't do here, I mean, because we have fun little raccoons and fun loaf, also. red, dough, bakery items, but that industrial momaster. We can take a lot of stuff that the backyard composting systems would not be able to handle. I put in like 7 piece of boxes. I did get yelled at for that, though, because I didn't bring it down. But you can really use those industrial accomplishments for a lot. So even if you are not maintaining a backyard go-go spin, you can use the same ingredients and give them to us or the TV divorce. Sometimes food waste can really build up, especially when it's like empty refrigerator day. I know that always happens to me.

And it might not be the easiest thing to use it in your backyard composting system. But with us, you can accept so much with a name so industrial, so many duty. Um, right? Right now, with our congos. Our temperatures are rechanging, between the 130 each of the 160. So I know it's working. It is breaking down. I'm not seeing huge chunks of wood. I'm not seeing tons of sticks or food. avocado pits of big art. those are really tough to break down. But I'm washing it turned into soil, and it's kind of magical, kind of in vessel unit. It's breaking down very quickly and it's, I would say it's broken down. faster than any backyard pro posting system I've seen.

So that's been really incredible. And that's including lots of different products like dairy that you wouldn't usually put us out of the back one. Like there is killing the passages, making sure that there is no weed seeds left. There's, it has been really, really working and it's been amazing. Um, I know you're probably thinking, what are we possibly going to do with all those combos after? So right now, like I said, we are hitting the degrees for it to be ready. and we are almost past this 17,000 miles of good waste. And I believe the machine can hit about 20. Whenever we're done, the 1st thing we're gonna do is try to hear it, and we're just carrying it the old-fashioned way about putting it outside, letting the heat dissipate, making sure there are no large chunks or any mulch, like no pieces, no food, no odors, no smells. Once it's giving, a lot of soil composure, then we're gonna start hearing it outside. With that, we are going to then disperse it by giving it to our ground maintenance team. A lot of our people in Beaufort County, who are taking care of our flowers downtown. A lot of our folks who are helping with our trees. A lot of our storm water folks are helping plant things to help with erosion, are going to need that healthy, nutrient, dense soil that can really absorb a lot of water. So we're gonna be using it 1st for towards ground maintenance. And then we want to try to get it back, give it back and get it back to the community. Like I was saying, we are right now fully running on grants. It would be so amazing to be able to sell some of our compos to provide sustainability for our program, to be able to keep them going, to keep so many of our areas green and healthy and to create all those that's available for the community.

And I just want to say, thank you guys so much for listening to me today. I think we're doing good on time right now. I'm going to go over, but I am working so hard with the county to try to produce some gardens of our own. I would really like to start some green spaces and holiday gardens in Inver County, using the resident compost, to really illustrate and educate one of the fuller gold system of what our food waste of our fresh can become, and to create more beautiful, more green spaces for our natural animals, environments, and plants, animals, and for our guests in our community. ways you guys can support us. If you have any questions or want any classes, please reach out to me. I would love to come to any more individual classes and teach about where we come hosting, bringing a backyard compost example, even showing you guys that it is the industrial

compost machine. I'd love to do a tour refreshing. it's really cool. By sharing Henry and all the information you have with others, asking restaurants, if you can, if they are... holiday in their gardens and our compost-based gardens, please let me know. I'm starting a volunteer group with our county, all things and routes, and I would love to have some support from all you fabulous gardeners on how we can keep our area free and beautiful. Thank you guys so much for listening again. It's been a pleasure. Thank you very much, honey.

So from a practical point of view for our members. Okay, you know, the whole team isn't going to want a big compost or sitting on somebody's penny. Now, from a practical sense, can members, if they don't have space in their gardens, can they come close to home and take it to their garden? I know some members just bury stuff. You know, if they cut lettuce or something like that, they'll just bury in land in the garden. And also brown, green ratio. Yeah. Hello? So how more practical? As I said before, you're always more than welcome to bring it to us of the county. But again, if you're just doing this at home and you're trying to keep it small, you can always start with a heavy ground ratio. So those are your carbon rich products, and then modern, doing a modern amount of food waste, modern amount of veggies, modern amount of veggies, craps, and bruised craps, and growing ahead is starting a mixing system in a rotating system with you at home. This does not have to be during day. As long as you're going to start to generate a little bit of heat. That's how you do all of that breaking down. And it should not stink either because it's got all those garbage products. Yeah. And one challenge that I have noticed, whenever you're doing, a close proximity amount of food waste of diary is fruit flies, something that's helped a lot for me is just making sure you're moderating your pile of wetness. Whenever you're grabbing your compos, make sure it's giving more of a spongy texture and not a soggy or a swampy texture. Because those group labs are nap based, and that's probably the biggest deterrent for a lot of people for composting as pests. Um, but yeah, when you're doing it at home to keep it practical, you can do small, make sure you're maintaining that heat. And all of those animals on boxes storm in there. Get those ground in there, make sure that it's getting rotated and really, um, really gets them together. But again, if anybody is interested in starting home hosting Woodley County today, I have my QR code here. I'm happy to walk you through it. And I have a couple of these composting buckets. If anybody is interested in bringing a rock home with a little guy. I have a quick tips on reducing food waste. I have a compost backyard magnet. So anybody who's interested in getting started right now. This is very practical and very easy to read. Um, and then our knee hack, who helps us a lot with our grains, our compost it, and don't waste it. So this is awesome. So say you're compost is starting to smell like eggs. What would that possibility mean? They got an answer for it. They've got everything in here. Um, outside of it up. I have lots of fun tricks on recycling and everything that we can take in the county and some really great stickers too, some other educational options. Thank you.

